

Chapter 56-2

As the most beautiful, coldest-natured, and most professionally capable doctor of her age group in the hospital, Zhao Xuning was called the "flower on a high peak"¹ by doctors and nurses.

And the most difficult one to pluck.

So when she and Shen Hui stood confronting each other in the hospital corridor like this, many people heard the commotion and came running, with news spreading through various group chats.

Whether they had business on this floor or not, everyone wanted to come see the excitement.

And Shen Hui had been facing away with her back turned the whole time.

The group of young nurses had already exploded into chaos.

"Wuwuwu, I just saw Doctor Zhao seemed to be crying."

"Her eyes are so red it breaks my heart."

"Is that her girlfriend? Doesn't look like it though."

"Our Doctor Zhao is single! As long as she's single, I have a chance!"

"This is the first time I've seen Doctor Zhao like this, that expression is so pitiful."

"If her interns saw this, their filter² for Doctor Zhao would probably shatter too."

"My filter for her has gotten even deeper, wuwuwu, like a poor little puppy."

"....."

"Am I the only one curious about what that lady looks like?"

"I saw her, absolutely stunning!"

"Is she an older sister or younger sister³!"

"Looks like an older sister, really, her beauty is indescribable with words!"

"That's all temperament built up with money, her whole outfit adds up to over 400,000 yuan."

"Damn! She's way out of my league!"

"....."

More and more gazes turned their way, but Zhao Xuning didn't care. She just suppressed the urge to pull Shen Hui, her sweaty palms curling and releasing in her pockets.

Seeing that Shen Hui's expression had softened somewhat, she spoke gently again: "Come eat with me, we can talk about whatever it is after we eat, okay?"

Shen Hui glanced at her, said nothing, and just turned and walked away.

Zhao Xuning immediately followed.

Because she knew that for Shen Hui, not refusing meant tacit agreement.

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Only after the two of them left did Xu Qingzhu come out of the hospital room.

Although reason told her she shouldn't be curious, people inevitably can't control their curiosity.

And the group of nurses in the corridor had already started discussing just how much Doctor Zhao could spoil someone when in love.

Someone said with envy and longing: "I really want to date Doctor Zhao."

"Forget it." Someone said with great self-awareness: "I'm not worthy of Doctor Zhao."

Everyone: "....."

That seemed about right.

Liang Shi was still unconscious, and Xu Qingzhu stayed in the hospital room for a long time.

It wasn't until nearly evening that Xu Qingzhu left the room.

She went to the restroom.

After coming out, she bent over to wash her hands, water flowing over her fingers and wrapping around every inch of her skin, but she was in a daze.

She was thinking about Zhao Xuning's question, and also thinking about Shen Hui's answer.

"If she were a completely new person, would you love her?"

"One cannot step into the same river twice."

A very philosophical conversation.

For Xu Qingzhu, she really couldn't figure it out.

Fortunately, she wasn't someone who got obsessed with such things. It was just that now that things were quiet, this question appeared in her mind.

She didn't follow Shen Hui's answer, nor did she force herself to definitely figure it out.

She just felt: let nature take its course.

Many things don't necessarily need answers, especially when it comes to emotions.

So what if there were answers?

Ninety percent of things in this world can be completed independently, so one should think of firm goals and find the right direction. But only emotions—they need two people to construct.

It's not something one person can decide alone.

No matter how much she agonized over it, it would be meaningless.

Moreover, the most important thing right now was Minghui Jewelry.

In this regard, she thought very clearly.

Just as she was lost in thought, a clear voice sounded beside her ear: "The water is overflowing."

Only then did Xu Qingzhu come to her senses, discovering that the water in the sink had already overflowed. She immediately turned off the faucet and pressed down the drain.

Clear water flowed down through the drain.

She said warmly: "Thank you."

But when she saw the other person's face, she was momentarily stunned.

"It's you." Xu Qingzhu said in a lowered voice, with a hint of disbelief.

"Mm." Without Zhao Xuning around, Shen Hui bore no hostility toward her, only answering in a very casual tone: "It's me."

Footnotes:

¹ "高嶺之花" - A Japanese-origin idiom meaning "flower on a high peak," referring to someone who is beautiful/excellent but unattainable or out of reach.

² "濾鏡" - Literally "filter," but in internet slang refers to having a good impression or idealized view of someone.

³ In Chinese culture, it's common to refer to women as "姐姐" (older sister) or "妹妹" (younger sister) based on apparent age or as terms of endearment, regardless of actual relationship.